



THE FIGHT FOR AMERICA'S FAMILIES

Exposing the Corruption in Family Courts and CPS.

They took my kids. They tried to silence me. They WON'T.

FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 37

OKLAHOMA

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — the first cross-state dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Oklahoma's family courts and child-welfare system.

75

OKLAHOMA FAMILIES ON RECORD ·
125 CHILDREN IMPACTED · 11
MONTHS MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF
PARENTING TIME

REPORT GENERATED

MAY 7, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED

28 OF 77

COMPILED BY

MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS · OKLAHOMA

A name appears below only after 3 or more independent families have named the same actor in Oklahoma. Submitter names, emails, and contact details are never published. Comments below are direct family reports — one per family — with all identifying information removed.

Cynthia PickeringJUDGE · OKMULGEE COUNTY · **3 FAMILIES**

"Took my kids in an ex parte guardianship with no evidence other than a sworn statement from my abusers parents and him terminating his legal rights to them. I'm currently facing arraignment for indirect contempt for speaking about my case and answering my kids messages when they ran away from abuse suffered at the home of the guardians/ paternal grandparents"

"Ignored evidence on my part. Had a private meeting with the defendants attorney without my attorney present with lead the defendant to know exactly how our case was going to turn out." **OKMULGEE COUNTY FAMILY COURT**

"She has left it up to the attorneys to figure out details regarding visitations and we have not been to court since. Even though the schedules are not being followed correctly." **OKMULGEE**

Public threshold rule: Names are grouped conservatively by normalized spelling, role, and location. Common titles, punctuation, casing, and middle initials collapse together. Close misspellings are not auto-merged without admin review. Only family-direct submissions count toward the public threshold.

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

OKLAHOMA AT A GLANCE.

Across 75 Oklahoma families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED 125 73 of 75 families reported child counts	MEDIAN FAMILY BURDEN \$101,500 median across 35 families reporting 3+ categories	MEDIAN MONTHS LOST 11 of parenting time	WENT PRO SE 49.3% 44.0% after running out of money
SUBMISSIONS 75	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY 1.7	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN 73 of 75	COUNTIES REPRESENTED 28

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Oklahoma families — and families in every state — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · [STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com)

03 THE COST OF OKLAHOMA FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	54	\$20,000	\$36,503	\$1,971,150
Lost Wages	40	\$12,500	\$32,120	\$1,284,800
Other Court Fees	20	\$2,000	\$9,086	\$181,720
Therapy / Evaluations	34	\$2,000	\$5,338	\$181,500
Reunification Services	27	\$2,000	\$3,381	\$91,285
GAL Fees	28	\$5,000	\$9,611	\$269,100
Asset Loss ¹	32	\$25,000	—	—
Median Family Burden (35 families reporting 3+ categories)	—	\$101,500	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers. **Median Family Burden** is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported costs in 3 or more expense categories with a combined total of at least \$1,000 — a true median of real family totals, restricted to families who filled out enough of the financial section to characterize their case and excluding obvious data-entry artifacts.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median (\$25,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

Median months lost		11	0.9 yrs
Mean months lost		25	2.1 yrs
Total across all families		1,438	119.8 yrs

04 WHO IS REPORTING · OKLAHOMA

Most families documenting in Oklahoma are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed		34	45%
Not provided		14	19%
Case closed: within last 2 years		12	16%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago		8	11%
Not in court but still affected		2	3%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Both Family Court and CPS		36	48%
Family Court Only		23	31%
CPS (Child Protective Services) Only		9	12%
Unknown		5	7%
Judicial Abuse / Retaliation		1	1%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years		25	33%
5 – 10 years		16	21%
6 months – 1 year		9	12%
3 – 5 years		8	11%
Over 10 years		6	8%

CUSTODY STATUS

No Contact / Total Loss of Access		23	31%
Visitation Only		22	29%
50/50 Joint		10	13%
Full Custody		9	12%
Children in Foster Care		6	8%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Tulsa		7	9%
Okmulgee		5	7%
Canadian		5	7%
Oklahoma		3	4%
Creek		3	4%
Wagoner		2	3%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)		27	36%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)		11	15%
High Conflict Divorce		9	12%
Other: (Short answer)		7	9%
Other		5	7%

05 PARENT VOICES — OKLAHOMA

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Oklahoma comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.



CPS caused mental and emotional trauma. They made it to where I am traumatized to call 911 for any help. They stripped away motherhood.

— LINSEY

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

My children are being told that their parents are unsafe. My family is falling apart, my son has no idea who his parents are. There is no proof or evidence supporting their claims to my children. Our children are traumatized. My husband and are exhausted and so sad that we [...]

— OKLAHOMA PARENT · ANASTASIA

MORE VOICES FROM OKLAHOMA

Took my children away for 21 days with no contact with me or them, separated my children, didn't care to listen to my case, gave my kids to an abuser, mental anguish towards my children and I.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system destroyed my relationships with my three children irreparable harm has been done and there isn't a way to fix it.

— KATIE

It has destroyed my relationship with my children. It has destroyed me financially and emotionally.

— RAY

They have stripped us of any human rights we thought we had. And destroyed our mental health. What has been taken can never be replaced. We grasp at the few strands of hope that float through the time we are allowed to have with our children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



My ex husband was abusive which had been proven, he was also a very absent father after the divorce to our 4 children, he got really behind on child support & refused to pay, so he showed up took our teen son (which was just turning 13 at the time) used him as a weapon against [...]

— BRANDY

At 13 my son wanted to live with his dad in another state. Now at 15 he reports abuse and a strong desire to return home and he is being silenced and not allowed to share his story with the judge. We've been in a holding pattern for nearly 3 years with a bias GAL awaiting trial.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Taken my children's childhood and my chance at being their mother without the chaos and trauma of their father and his hatred towards me.

— KRYSTAL

It has taken mine and my child's life away from us. It has put my daughter Hracie in more danger. It has violated our constitutional rights while giving our abuser more power.

— HAILIE

My biggest regret in life is telling the truth and following the law. I reported abuse. My family has been destroyed as a result.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The judge said get along or your children will rebuild and grow up in the system. I was told one of us had to love our children enough to let go. I just didn't realize it would cost me again for the rest of my life.

— DEBRA

stripped me of feeling human. "The hardest part isn't even what happened between us—it's how it affected my relationship with my kids."

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My son was illegally kidnapped from me by my abuser, because of his private connections with the Judge. I don't know if I'll ever get to see my son again. The Judge threatened this from day one. My life will never be the same. I don't know how much longer I can fight. I've lost [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have ruined my life and my relationship with my children.

— SHAUN

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



The psychological torture that we have experienced by the family Court system, the faulty DHS/CPS workers, the Visitation Center, the GAL, opposing counsel, and even our own attorneys is beyond imaginable. Take care of yourself if you are in the midst of this crisis.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system took my kids and gave them to my ex who was beating them and had charges on him for beating kids and will not work with me.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They stole my granddaughter and told the foster parents they could adopt her while my granddaughters parents still had their parental rights.

— JAMIE

This system has lied and manipulated over and over. Destroyed my kids future and their belief of their mom. They'll never believe the actual truth because they've brain washed them!!

— CRYSTAL

Destroyed me and my sons relationship, my son and daughters relationship, stolen time and memories that we will never get back. Stolen my son's entire childhood from me.

— KATLYN

Destroyed, shattered but we're strong and we will survive and be stronger. The pain and suffering is unimaginable

— KIMBERLY

Took my son from me and said they could protect and care for him better than I could. Then they allowed him to leave their "safe and secure" environment while mentally unstable, and he was killed while in CPS custody. Kota ☐ forever 17

— JOLLEEN

My entire life to enjoy was stolen trying to defend myself. Now my grandchildren have tried to kill themselves because they have used a false substantiated that dismissed. They can't seem to have a system to correct errors

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

We have been informed that CPS, the judge AND "my" public defender (I have not met the judge or the public defender yet) have already met and made agreements before I even got to court. I have been subpoenaed to hand over my kids before I have even been in court or received a [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



Removed me from my home for over 4 months. Taken away all parenting rights to my daughter. Separated me from my step children for the past 4 months.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Family court has literally destroyed my whole family and my two beautiful children. They have stole 6 years of our lives so far and have took every penny from us!!

— ASHLEY

Children were sold to my ex whom wanted revenge on for leaving them. I am my children's only biological family,

— DOMINIQUE

GAL refused to actively look into anything and still doesn't reply.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family court system in Tulsa county is a joke and completely corrupt. Attorneys have been allowed to drag this case out for over 5 years, then a joke of a GAL is assigned. The GAL has been unapologetically one sided with the mother. She is known around the town as [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Loss of grandson, loss of nephew to our then 3 year old daughter. Irreparable emotional loss & family loss.

— STEPH

Destroyed the very Oath that they are supposed to uphold that protects the least of is us. Left 4 wondered honor students without a remedy for the heart.

— DWIGHT

Kidnapped my daughter and robbed me of her raising. They also robbed my daughter a life with her mother in it. Legal kidnapping is real and it must be exposed.

— ADRIENNE

It has complete destroyed us completely..

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05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



The system has tore my family apart, my 4 year old under the influence that her home is unsafe and can not come home because of it. My kids feel as if their mother and I don't love them anymore because they have been out of the home for so long.

— DENZIL

Removed children ex parte with no evidence and no third party statements that children were at risk with me in any way, then given to a third party who never requested guardianship.

— HOPE

It has destroyed our life, our health, our stability, our safety, and our peace. It has stolen our joy, my son's innocence, childhood, and my motherhood.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My children are now scared of law enforcement officers after being taken at gunpoint with no warrant and given to the abusers parents with an ex parte guardianship

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The courts let him continue to abuse us by using the system.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Severed and destroyed the mother/child bond. Caused severe emotional & mental health injuries. Harmed extended family members and countless other personal relationships.

— JEANA

They have done a grave injustice toward my family, torn apart by lies and corruption ,and they need to face justice for what they've done to countless families like my own.

— MISTY

The Court has severed a loving and nurturing relationship between a devoted father/parent and his children, inflicting profound emotional harm while unjustly destroying his reputation and destabilizing his financial life.

— FRANKIE

They tore my family apart... and left me to be swallowed up by the system. I'm staying strong in my belief. God will make a way

— ROBERT

60 Oklahoma parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 42 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — OKLAHOMA

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Oklahoma families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

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— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

My ex husband was abusive which had been proven, he was also a very absent father after the divorce to our 4 children, he got really behind on child support & refused to pay, so he showed up took our teen son (which was just turning 13 at the time) used him as a weapon against me to make up false allegations & drag me through the court system in order to get out of the legal consequences of not paying child support, he bribed our teen son to say things, he even got temporary protective order and though all professionals that investigated the situation said there was as no truth to what my ex husband was claiming- he was still able to keep my son from myself, and his siblings (the only family he had consistently had in his life) for almost 2 full years without us having any contact. I went from being the only parent that ever cared for him his entire life, to being shoved out of the picture for almost 2 years over false allegations. And the court system allowed all this to happen. Now my son is back home for 2 years now, , my ex-husband was able to get out of all consequences of the back child support owed, has not visited any of his children since and now my son that was used as this weapon in the court system, has severe behavioral and mental health issues that I am now dealing with and trying to help him recover from all the trauma that was caused & allowed by the court system.

— BRANDY

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— FRANKIE

They tore my family apart... and left me to be swallowed up by the system. I'm staying strong in my belief. God will make a way

— ROBERT

They tore us apart, they are the reason I stayed in the abuse until he finally tried to kill me because I knew what would happen to us in okmulgee county

— CJ

It's an 'our way or no way' system that tries to force compliance, tears families apart, and leaves lasting harm in its wake.

— DAYNA

This system has torn my family apart, stripped me of my role as a mother, and forced me into a relentless fight against abusive exes, distortion, imbalance, and Court decisions that have harmed both me and my child.

— TATIANA

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The system failed me and my family.

— CHELSEY

Caused irreplaceable harm, lost previous memory building time, created a chasm in the family relationship

— SUZANNE

This system has torn our family apart, stripping me of my child through false accusations and leaving us to navigate a nightmare we never deserved. It has inflicted lasting emotional damage, replacing our stability with fear, confusion, and heartbreak.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has separated me from my children from three years. I still legally have full custody. They haven't ruled on anything. I don't know where the Mother is. She's in a whole Nother state. The courts didn't rule on their own court order said they didn't have jurisdiction had enough jurisdiction to do my paperwork to where the Mother has them and the case is still not being dealt with. I still legally have full custody.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I've learned that if you are a man who filed for a divorce, you automatically lose every thing you worked for. To include all money and assets

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has destroyed my life, my reputation and taken my child without a proper investigation. It has been a man hunt amd lynching without hearing facts or following the rights of the parent. Do not have the best interests of child in mind amd are trying to destroy family in another state after threateningg to do so.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I have been diagnosed with PTSD, depression, severe anxiety. Finding a job has been difficult, being able to afford any housing...which I lost my marital home AND could no longer afford my car payment or rent. I have nothing. I hide from people so I don't risk someone asking about my kids. I no longer have friends or family. I have shut myself off to even my husband. I have medical problems I never had until my ex husband came after me and took my kids away. I pray that God will come in the night and take me so I don't have to feel this pain any more.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Family court has shown me that children and families come last. They have facilitated and enabled conflict that has cost me and my daughter years and tens of thousands of dollars.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ever since my child was born, even before I've been a domestic abuse situation. The reason I left their situation is because the father my child threatened to kill my grandparents while he was drunk, waving a gun in the air, which pointed at me and my son and I had to grab the end of the barrel before it went off and he kept throwing things and acting crazy. Then we went to court and they said that I was mentally insane and that we had 50-50 custody my evidence was not shared and ignored fast-forward today I have been through domestic view chase down with the car yelled at screamed at throw stuff at but everything is being ignored even with the proof I've had Now today. I am happily married with the baby on the way, but now they're trying to take away my child saying that we abused him which we did not . The other part's mother is coming up the traps working for Dhs. I believe that my son was abused in his father's care and they're trying to blame it on us. There's false allegations and everyone is believing them. I have proof that my son comes back even now bruises, black eyes and busted lip even has came back with broken bones from his dad house while they're on vacation and stayed there not seeking my son at proper casting or care.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

It has torn my family apart and made me miss out on my only child's life and her most important moments in life and it has made me think of committing suicide. I am lost without my child and she is my reason for living and to be able to have someone who isn't related to your child go to the court house and file false accusations on you and get guardianship of your child and then be told you can't prove them a liar because they won't accept all your evidence to prove that your not what they claim and then be told that I cant have visitation or calls with your child is devastating. My child cries everyday to come home and has told her school counselor she wants to come home and that her step mom is horrible to her and that she kidnapped her just to punish me and my child's father cause he divorced her

— FRANCIS

The family court system did not just fail me — it empowered coercive control, ignored financial abuse, and allowed narratives to replace evidence. I was painted as unstable and uncooperative while being denied access to critical financial information and meaningful due process. The damage was not only legal or financial; it fractured my family and weaponized the very system that was supposed to protect us.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I refused to pay anything but I provided groceries, clothing and all my child needs. My case was very strange. It was the 1st that my child had ever been away from me and the only time she was ever neglected it abused was during her time in foster care. So many things they inflicted on us and it didn't stop there. They also came after my granddaughter bc she lived with me. I've actually had around 21 years of them lying, harassing and falsifying complaints against me but only being able to keep me from my child for about 7-8 months! They were so wrong that I took my child back from the foster home and kept her without any reprimand, that's unheard of but they didn't want exposure is what I'm thinking.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My daughters are now recovering from sexual assault perpetrated by foster parents who bragged to me about it without ever being charged. My whole family lives in fear of going to jail over things like camping, practicing the "wrong religion", our ethnic heritage being used as a crime, and being forced apart if we need mental health assistance because we were told that we don't have rights unless CPS allows them.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I has threated in front of my counsel who did not come to my aid but opposing counsel in an informal mediation I was pressured into that if I didnt accept the terms of opposing counsel, they would seek full custody and I would have one weekend a month and would continue to file motions until this happened. My son was uprooted from a school he did well at as a neurodivergent child and it has caused problems every since. I am limited in the medical care I can get for my son and its hard to fight for his school rights in this new school because I dont have school decision making authority. You can connect me and I can tell more but my case is stuck in court so I need to protect my identity

— ANGIE

It has caused a tremendous amount of stress on my family. It has taken a lot of parenting away from me where I have missed a lot of important milestones.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

60 full approved Oklahoma comments are included in this appendix.

07 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT**WHAT THIS IS**

The Family Rights Registry is a national, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Oklahoma report comes from Oklahoma respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Oklahoma — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 75 Oklahoma families reporting here are not the universe of Oklahoma families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. We flag outliers and report medians when means are distorted (see page 3, note 1). The Median Family Burden headline is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported in three or more expense categories. Quotes are minimally edited.

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Data in this report was collected April 2024 – May 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

When a respondent's financial entry differs from the population by more than three standard deviations, the mean is suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte-Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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